# Monday Nite Footballers Predictions

By Jim Nunnelly

## Green Bay Packers, NFC Champions

## vs.

## Denver Broncos, AFC Champions

### Qualcomm Stadium, San Diego, Cal.

### Sunday, Jan. 25, At 5 P.M.

### KSHB-TV, Channel 41

| MEMBER | PREDICTION | COMMENT |
|---|---|---|
| Charles Allen | Packers by 7 | Continued NFC dominance! |
| Paul Booker | Denver by 6 | Better team! |
| Carl Clark | Packers by 10 | Supporting cast superior! |
| Ike Gardner | Packers by 10 | NFC's defense is better than AFC's offense. |
| Lloyd Greenfield | Denver by 6 | It's Elway turn! |
| Ollie Hubbard | Denver by 10 | Change is gonna come! |
| Walt Livingston | Denver by 20 | Lucky! |
| Jim Nunnelly | Denver by 3 | John Elway, MVP! |
| Harry Sypert | Denver by 3 | Mile High satellite! |
| Ed West | Packers by 14 | Turnovers, turnovers! |

### John Elway: Take A Bow On Super Bowl Sunday

John Elway is after all used to being on center stage and at the center of attention. That's understandable. He was the first athlete picked in the 1983 draft. He passed up a chance to play baseball for the Yankees. For starters he's brought Denver back to 40 some victories after being behind in the fourth quarter. All that and he's never won a Super Bowl and time is running out on the 15-year All-Pro quarterback.

Before we review Elway's chances for victory in Sunday's Super Bowl game against Green Bay, let's look back and see how "other" quarterbacks have upstaged Elway in past Super Bowl games.

First off, there was Phil Simms at Super Bowl XXI... when the New York Giants quarterback completed 22 of 25 passes that afternoon in Pasadena. Then in Super Bowl XXIV in 1990, Joe Montana passed five touchdowns, helping the 49ers to a 55-10 trouncing of the Broncos. There's more.

But, it was the 1988 Super Bowl that "Big John" will vividly remember. That was "Doug Day afternoon." Quarterback Doug Williams put on a record setting, passing clinic for Elway and African Americans everywhere. Being the first black quarterback to start a Super Bowl, Williams threw four touchdown passes in the second quarter, one for 80 yards to Ricky Sanders. And when it was all over, the Washington Redskins had dwarfed Elway and the Broncos 42-10. Grambling's favorite son and now coach was selected the game's Most Valuable Player, again upstaging one-way Elway. One more time.

But, like many of his comeback victories, Elway has another chance this Sunday. In fact, Ollie Hubbard, Paul Booker, and hate nable Harry Sypert believe it's Denver's time this year. Some others are just loyal to the American Football Conference, who hasn't produced a winning Super Bowl since Marcus Allen starred for the Los Angeles Raiders, way back in Super Bowl XVIII.

Will John Elway once again be the "other" quarterback, taking a back seat to Green Bay's Brett Favre? Carl Clark puts it best when he says Elway has a "cast of supporting characters" and that makes Elway a star and a winner this time.

In years past, he didn't have a Shannon Sharpe, or a running back like Terrell Davis, who on any given day can equal Barry Sanders. And, most of all, he didn't have a young, big-play, wide receiver like Missouri Southerner's Rod Smith. Mix that in with defensive giant Neil Smith and Keith Traylor and you will see clearly why John Elway will get the last bow on Sunday. San Diego will not be able to hold all the hoopla when the Broncos package the Packers. And Dear John will be on the shoulders of his team mates. The TV cameras will be all in his face. He would have done it, won the "big one." And he'll take a bow, right out in the middle of field, where 134 million people will clap and stand up.

Take a bow, John. This Bud's for you.

### Sunday's Super Bowl Tidbits

• Doug Williams, record-setting Most Valuable Player of Super Bowl XXII, will be part of the opening, coin-toss ceremonies. Williams was the first African American quarterback to start a Super Bowl. Now head coach at Grambling where he played college football, Williams will share pre-game honors with his old coach of the Washington Redskins, Joe Gibbs.

• 134 million people will watch Sunday's Denver-Green Bay Super Bowl. The game will start at 5:12 p.m. and can be seen on Channel 41 (NBC network).

• Lots of creative commercials will be launched on Sunday. Advertisers are paying 1.3 million dollars for each 30 second spot.

• Ralph Brown, owner and operator of the Sportsmen's House of Coiffures, will attend the Super Bowl in San Diego this Sunday. He has been to every Super Bowl but one since the Chiefs in 1970.

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